

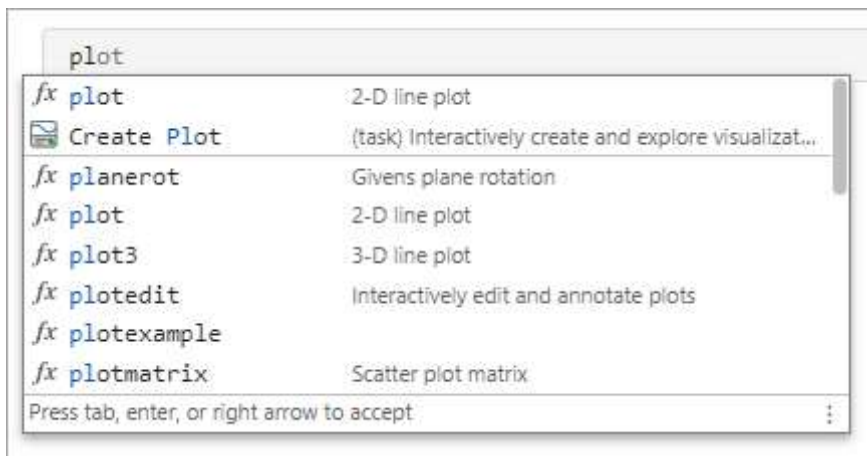
Autocomplete Code Using Suggestions

When you write code in the Command Window, Editor, Live Editor, and App Designer, MATLAB® provides real-time suggestions as you type. These suggestions include the names of functions, models, MATLAB objects, files, folders, variables, structures, graphics properties, Live Editor tasks, and code snippets. In addition, when you type a function name, MATLAB shows basic syntax information for the function and offers suggestions for arguments and options.

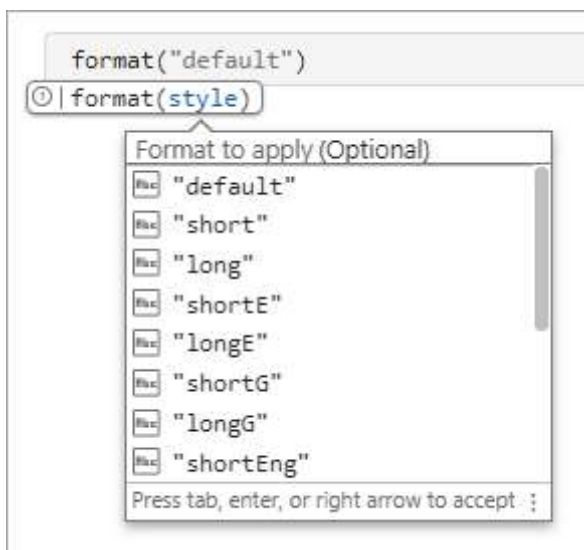
Name Suggestions

As you type, MATLAB shows the most relevant name suggestions based on the text you entered. To show new and more refined suggestions, continue typing. If a list of suggestions does not appear, press **Ctrl+Space** or **Tab** to show the list. If there are no suggestions, MATLAB displays No suggestions.

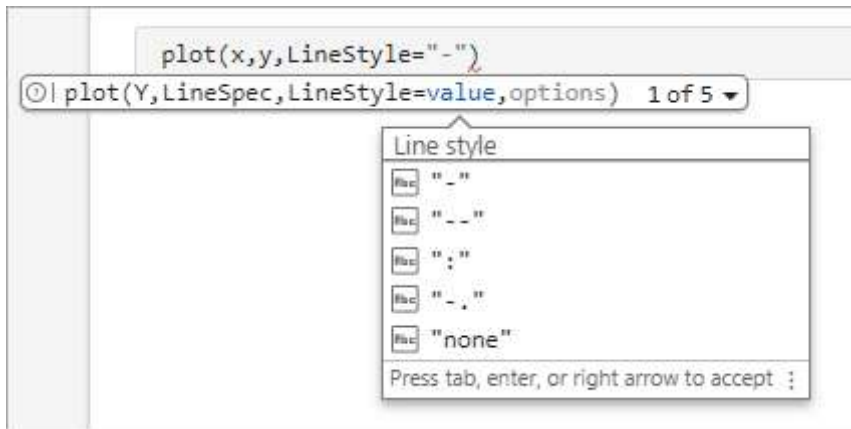
To insert a suggestion in your code, use the arrow keys to select the suggestion and then accept it by pressing **Tab**, **Enter**, or the right arrow key. To dismiss the list of suggestions without selecting anything, press **Esc**.



Name suggestions help complete function arguments and options. For example, type `format(` and use suggestions to complete the `format` to apply.



In addition, name suggestions help complete name-value arguments that set graphics properties. For example, type `plot(x,y,LineStyle=` and use suggestions to complete the value of the `LineStyle` argument.

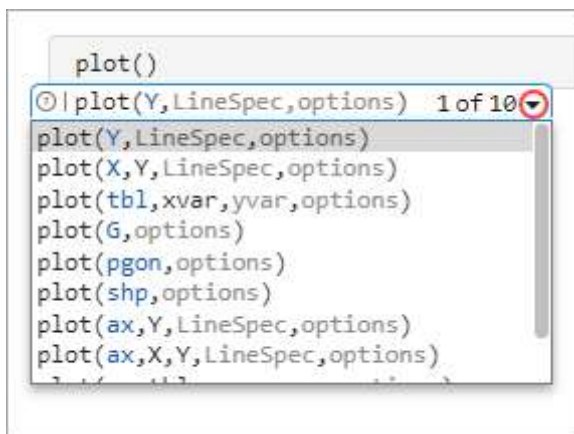


MATLAB displays suggestions based on:

- The current workspace variables.
- Files and folders on the search path or in the current folder.
- Variables, functions, class properties, and class methods defined in the active document and available at the current cursor location. Field names of structure arrays defined within the active document are not included.

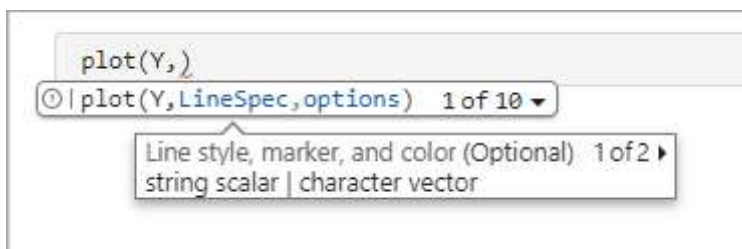
Function Syntax Suggestions

When you type the name of a function followed by a (, MATLAB shows basic syntax information for the function. If a function has multiple syntaxes, use the drop-down arrow to the right of the syntax or press **Ctrl+down arrow** to show all available syntaxes. On macOS systems, use **Command+down arrow** instead.



You can type an input for any argument that appears in blue. Enter your own input variables or values, not the argument names shown in the suggestion. The displayed syntax suggestions change based on the arguments you enter.

For each argument, MATLAB shows a description and indicates whether the argument is optional. If MATLAB suggests multiple arguments, click the arrow to the right of the argument description or press **Ctrl+Alt+right arrow** and **Ctrl+Alt+left arrow** to view the additional arguments. To open the documentation page for the function, click the Help button to the left of the function syntax suggestion.

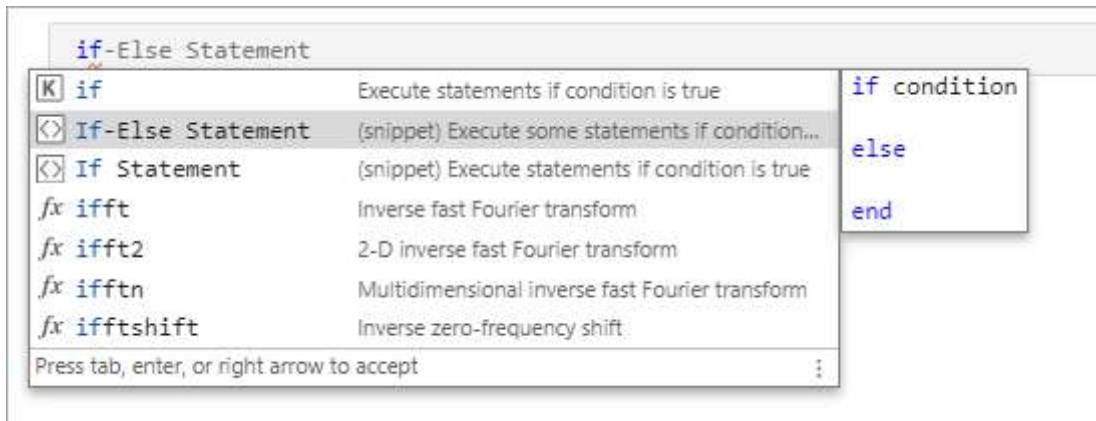


Custom Functions

Suggestions for functions that you create come from your function definition files and require that the files be on the search path or in the current folder. For more information about customizing these suggestions, see [Customize Code Suggestions and Completions](#).

Code Snippets

Code snippets are templates that simplify adding recurring code structures, such as loops or conditional statements, to your code. As you type in the Editor or Live Editor, MATLAB shows relevant code snippets along with other name suggestions. For example, if you type the word `if`, MATLAB suggests the `If-Else Statement` and `If Statement` snippets in addition to functions whose name starts with `if`.



To insert a code snippet in your code, use the arrow keys to select the suggestion and then accept it by pressing **Tab**, **Enter**, or the right arrow key. To dismiss the list of suggestions without selecting anything, press **Esc**.

Insert Tabs

The **Tab** key provides a way to interact with real-time suggestions from MATLAB. However, if you just want to insert a tab character in your code, add a space before pressing **Tab**.

Alternatively, to disable showing suggestions when you press the **Tab** key, go to the **Home** tab, and in the **Environment** section, click **Settings**. Select **MATLAB > Suggestions** and then, to disable showing suggestions upon a **Tab** key press in the Command Window, clear the **Use Tab key to show suggestions (in addition to Ctrl+Space)** setting in the **Command Window** section. To disable showing suggestions upon a **Tab** key press in the Editor, Live Editor, and App Designer, clear the **Use Tab key to show suggestions (in addition to Ctrl+Space)** setting in the **Editor** section.

MATLAB always inserts a tab character if there are no available suggestions.

Modify Suggestions Settings

You can change how MATLAB suggests and completes names in the Command Window, Editor, Live Editor, and App Designer.

On the **Home** tab, in the **Environment** section, click **Settings**. Select **MATLAB > Suggestions**, and then adjust the settings as described in this table.

*In R2025a: Suggestions settings for the Command Window are located under **MATLAB > Command Window > Suggestions**. Suggestions settings for the Editor, Live Editor, and App Designer are located under **MATLAB > Editor/Debugger > Suggestions and Autocompletions**.*

*Before R2025a: Suggestions settings for the Command Window are located under **MATLAB > Command Window > Automatic Completions**. Suggestions settings for the Editor, Live Editor, and App Designer are located under **MATLAB > Editor/Debugger > Automatic Completions**.*

Setting	Usage
General	Select Use Right Arrow to accept suggestions (in addition to Tab and Enter) to accept suggestions using the right arrow key in the Command Window, Editor, Live Editor, and App Designer. Clear Use Right Arrow to accept suggestions (in addition to Tab and Enter) to accept suggestions using the Tab and Enter keys.
	Select Show suggestions tips to show a footer at the bottom of the suggestions window with tips on how to configure suggestions. Clear Show suggestions tips to hide the footer.
	Click the Reset Suggestions Window Size button to reset the suggestions window to its original size.
Command Window	Select Show suggestions as you type to automatically show suggestions as you type in the Command Window. Clear Show suggestions as you type to show suggestions only when you press Ctrl+Space or the Tab key.
	Select Use Tab key to show suggestions (in addition to Ctrl+Space) to show suggestions when you press the Tab key in the Command Window. Clear Use Tab key to show suggestions (in addition to Ctrl+Space) to show suggestions only when you press Ctrl+Space .
	Select Tab key accepts only on one suggestion to only accept a suggestion with the Tab key in the Command Window if it is the sole suggestion. Clear Tab key accepts only on one suggestion to accept the first suggestion when you press the Tab key.
Editor	Select Show suggestions as you type to automatically show suggestions as you type in the Editor, Live Editor, and App Designer. Clear Show suggestions as you type to show suggestions only when you press Ctrl+Space or the Tab key.
	Select Use Tab key to show suggestions (in addition to Ctrl+Space) to show suggestions when you press the Tab key in the Editor, Live Editor, and App Designer. Clear Use Tab key to show suggestions (in addition to Ctrl+Space) to show suggestions only when you press Ctrl+Space .
	Select Tab key accepts only on one suggestion to only accept a suggestion with the Tab key in the Editor, Live Editor, and App Designer if it is the sole suggestion. Clear Tab key accepts only on one suggestion to accept the first suggestion when you press the Tab key.

See Also

Topics

[Check Syntax as You Type](#)

[Enter Statements in Command Window](#)

[Modify Command Window Settings](#)

YOU MIGHT ALSO BE INTERESTED IN

